

Noghal
Story of a Universe

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2026/09/09

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CHAPTER 1: THE NINE AGES OF NOGHAL



THE UNIVERSE
OF NOGHAL is developed across
nine ages - from creation to salvation.

1. THE AGE OF CREATION

In the beginning there was only potential, and from it the gods were born. Each god claimed a domain - fire, wind, stone, storm, and every law that bound the universe together - and each drew power from two sources: the worship of mortals, and the raw force of the domain itself. For every truth of the cosmos, a god existed to embody it.

2. THE AGE OF WAR

From the first element came two energies, and from those energies came Good and Evil - forces that ran through every living thing. The gods aligned, one side to empathy and peace, the other to hate and fear, and neither would yield. So began the Great War, angels against demons, worlds burning in the crossfire, until Arod and Eluna, the creators of the universe itself, chose to end it. They forged two crystals from the first element: the Run'Noor, a stone of darkness, and the Lo'Gaan, a crystal of light. The Lo'Gaan was placed in the temple of Re'Lak on the planet Noghal. The Run'Noor was hidden far across the galaxy. Mortals were left free to choose their own path.

3. THE AGE OF SILENCE

The universe, exhausted by war, fell quiet. Slowly, it healed.

4. THE AGE OF AWAKENING

On the planet Noghal, a new people rose from the silence: the Tar'Gon.

5. THE AGE OF EXODUS

The Tar'Gon had split long ago into two peoples - the Tar'Gon'Re, who lived humbly alongside nature, and the Tar'Gon'La, who had grown ambitious and proud. In the grand senate on

Noghal, the Shando'Ra Su'Rei Tem rose to warn the assembly: the Tar'Gon'La were searching for a weapon, and a shared vision had shown them where the search would lead.

The patriarch, So'Rem Tar, dismissed the warning. His people had already found what they sought - somewhere among the stars - and only needed to leave Noghal to claim it. His daughter, the future matriarch Sha'Lei Tar, backed the right of both peoples to vote, even as sorrowful glances passed between her and Su'Rei Tem, the man she loved but could not choose.

Su'Rei Tem argued passionately for peace over conquest, for diplomacy over darkness, and the Tar'Gon'Re cheered him. But when the vote was called, duty pulled Sha'Lei Tar to her family's side. The exodus passed. As the senate emptied, she and Su'Rei Tem shared one last, aching goodbye - she bound to her people's fate, he left behind with a promise that neither of them would ever stop loving the other. Within a moon, the Tar'Gon'La fleet left Noghal to search the stars for the weapon of shadow: the Run'Noor.

6. THE AGE OF HEALING

With the Tar'Gon'La gone, Noghal healed, and new life took root. Five great civilizations rose across the planet:

The *Krunark*, blue-scaled reptilian warriors of the frozen Krun-Triplets, ruled by honor codes and led by women, each tribe bound to a totem spirit and a fierce respect for the balance of nature.

The *Humans*, scattered and divided, ruled by regents beneath the King of Malron, a people of vast inequality who worshipped many gods - chief among them Lazon, god of light.

The *Elves*, graceful and magical, born of Grandaar's Forest of Life, who built their cities in the treetops and became the finest crystal smiths in the world, revering nature, balance, and the goddess of magic, Yar'Lona.

The *Dwarves* of Lork, stout miners and warriors who loved gold, combat, and beer in equal measure, and worshipped a staggering pantheon of gods for every occasion imaginable.

The *Xylanth*s, plant-born and rooted in the jungles of Xyr, first discoverers of crystal magic, who lived in deep symbiosis with the wilds they fiercely protected.

7. THE AGE OF DESTINY

Several hundred thousand years passed as the Tar'Gon'La searched the galaxy for the Run'Noor - the very same span in which, back on Noghal, the five civilizations of Chapter Six had time to rise, grow, and flourish undisturbed. At last, the search ended: the Tar'Gon'La found what they had sought. Their fleet returned to Noghal, landing in the Desert of the Damned on the continent of Zraa, unloading strange machines, golems, and drones before a world that had never seen their like. Rumors spread of messengers from the gods - until the matriarch, Sha'Lei Tar, stepped from her ship and looked into the eyes of the world she had come to conquer.

War followed. But this time, the five civilizations of Noghal - Krunark, Human, Elf, Dwarf, and Xylanth - set aside their differences and united for the first time in history. On the battlefield of Nar'Sheech, as the Run'Noor pulsed with dark power on its platform, Sha'Lei Tar hesitated. Across the carnage, Su'Rei Tem - still alive after those thousands of years - called out to her, reminding her of the woman she had once been, and of a love that had never died.

Her Counselor, sensing her wavering, struck her down before she could turn back. Su'Rei Tem ran to her through the chaos, catching her as she fell, killing the Counselor without even looking. The five heroes of the united civilizations sealed the Run'Noor with the power of the Lo'Gaan, and the darkness retreated. But Sha'Lei Tar died in Su'Rei Tem's arms, having chosen him - and peace - only when it was already too late.

The war was won. The five peoples stood together in the silence that followed. But hidden on the sealed Run'Noor, a device counted down - five thousand years - toward something that was never meant to be a final ending.

8. THE AGE OF GRIEF

Five thousand years passed. Noghal's civilizations, having absorbed the Tar'Gon'La's technology, became a space-faring society, their reach extended across neighboring star systems by crystal-powered engines. And then the timer reached zero. The Run'Noor stirred.

But the true danger was not the stone - it was Su'Rei Tem. Across five millennia, his grief for Sha'Lei Tar had never faded; it had hardened into something else entirely. When the Run'Noor awakened, he went to the dark gods himself and offered them everything they had ever wanted, in

exchange for one thing: her, restored.

They gave him something wearing her face - but not her. Confronted with proof that some losses cannot be undone, Su'Rei Tem broke completely. The dark gods took what he had promised them, and the man who had once been Noghal's greatest voice for peace was consumed by the very darkness he had tried to bargain with. The war that followed was lost. Across the galaxy, world after world went dark.

9. THE AGE OF SALVATION

A hundred thousand years later, the descendants of Noghal's five civilizations were fighting a war they had been slowly losing for an age. Scattered across a hundred worlds, watching those worlds fall one by one, they turned at last to a legend older than memory: the Heaven Ships.

Built before the mortal races existed, in the earliest days of the war of the gods, the Heaven Ships were never weapons - they were vessels made to contain darkness, not destroy it. No one had ever understood how to wake them. But the descendants of the five original heroes carried, in blood and memory, fragments of the knowledge needed.

Together, across a desperate season of war and archaeology, they pieced together the activation sequence - and reached, at last, into the darkness itself. Not to destroy Su'Rei Tem, who had been trapped inside that darkness for a hundred thousand years, conscious of everything he had done and lost. The Heaven Ships offered him what he had needed all along: not Sha'Lei Tar returned, for that could never be undone - but release. Permission to let the grief go.

He was not rescued. He was redeemed. He could not unmake the choice that had broken the universe - but at last, he could rest.

The galaxy, wounded but standing, endured. The five civilizations remained, together, as they had first stood on the battlefield of Nar'Sheech, over one thousand centuries before.